CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · NCERT-TYPE UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 13–17: **Saving the Gharial, The Elephant and the Tragopan, That Little Square Box, Marshlands, The Three Caskets** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The gharial is a: 1

(a) bird of prey **(b)** plant-eating lizard
(c) fish-eating crocodile **(d)** freshwater turtle

2. 'Reservoir' means: 1

(a) a large artificial lake for storing water
(b) a mountain pass
(c) a dry riverbed
(d) a forest clearing

3. Which of these best describes the narrator at the start? 1

(a) bold **(b)** angry **(c)** careless **(d)** nervous

4. The poem is made up of: 1

(a) three stanzas of five lines **(b)** a single long sentence of blank verse
(c) four quatrains **(d)** seven rhyming couplets

5. Portia lives at: 1

(a) Rome **(b)** Verona **(c)** Venice **(d)** Belmont

6. A female gharial usually lays about how many eggs? 1

(a) 50 **(b)** 15 **(c)** 500 **(d)** 5

7. A tragopan is: 1

(a) a snake **(b)** a mountain goat
(c) a type of fish **(d)** a brightly coloured pheasant

8. The narrator hesitates to tell the captain because he: 1

(a) is fond of the men **(b)** fears being questioned or laughed at
(c) does not know where the captain is **(d)** is asleep

9. The cranes are described as having: 1

(a) swift darting flight **(b)** loud cries
(c) heavy wings and lazy flight **(d)** bright feathers

10. Inside the gold casket Morocco finds: 1

(a) a skull and a scroll **(b)** a bag of coins
(c) Portia's portrait **(d)** a ring

11. A tangled gharial in a fishing net often could not: 1

(a) sleep **(b)** lay eggs
(c) feed **(d)** swim upstream only

12. The trout reacts to the reservoir by feeling: 1

(a) angry **(b)** sleepy
(c) pleased about the extra space **(d)** fearful

13. The mood of the story builds from tension to: 1

(a) humour **(b)** anger **(c)** calm sleep **(d)** sorrow

14. The mood of the poem is mainly: 1

(a) calm and quiet **(b)** terrifying
(c) angry **(d)** joyful and festive

15. Inside the lead casket Bassanio finds: 1

(a) nothing **(b)** a blinking idiot
(c) Portia's portrait **(d)** a skull

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. What was Project Crocodile? 2

17. Why can the poem be called a fable? 2

18. Who is Flannigan? 2

19. To what is twilight compared? 2

20. What did Bassanio find in the lead casket? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Who is Nerissa and what role does she play? 3

22. Describe the nesting habits of the female gharial. 3

23. What do we learn about human nature from the poem? 3

24. How does the author build suspense in the story? 3

OR

Explain the simile of the golden cups. 3

25. How did the Prince of Morocco behave when he arrived? 3

OR

Why is the gharial called an indicator of river health? 3

MASTERMIND

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. Write a descriptive paragraph (about 100 words) of an evening in a place you know, in the manner of the poem. 5

OR

Write a conversation (about 8 lines) between Morocco and Arragon after both fail. 5

27. Describe the nesting and parental care of gharials. 5

OR

Write a character sketch of the elephant. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 50 Marks

MASTERMIND